Neal T. Gillespie

Austin, TX 78729 • nealtgill@gmail.com • (513) 807-1705 • LinkedIn: linkedin.com/in/neal01

City of Round Rock — Library Assistant, Youth Services — Supplemental Answers

1. What is your highest level of education?

Bachelor's degree. B.A. in Strategic and Corporate Communication, Chapman University, 2023, with a minor in Business Administration.

2. How many years of customer service and/or library experience do you have?

Over two years.

3. Please describe that experience.

I have spent more than four years in continuous public-facing work. For a year I staffed the registrar service window at Chapman University's Fowler School of Law, where I was the first person students spoke to. I answered questions in person and by phone, explained procedures, processed over five hundred transcripts and exam records in PeopleSoft, and proctored examinations including individually proctored sittings for students with accommodations.

Since then I have worked in nonprofit development, assisting between 150 and 320 constituents by phone and email and coordinating check-in and on-site operations for events serving up to a thousand people. At the University of Austin I handled intake and documentation of library donations and was the on-site point of contact for visitor tours of the campus library, which is the closest I have come to public service inside a library.

In my current role I oversee a physical archive of printed materials and built the searchable catalog and database behind it, so patrons and staff can find things without going through me.

4. Are you bilingual? If so, in which languages?

No.

The posting calls bilingual ability a significant plus. Answer honestly.

5. Do you have experience working with youth and families?

No.

This is the honest answer and the real gap in this application. Answering yes on the strength of something thin would not survive an interview.

6. Please describe that experience.

I have not worked professionally with children or teens, and I would rather say so plainly than stretch something to fit.

What I can offer is the production side of youth services done well. Creating displays, bibliographies and promotional material that makes people want to turn up is literally my current job, in a different context. I design and produce printed material end to end, and I built the catalog behind an archive, so the reference half of a youth desk, which is helping someone find the right thing and understanding why the catalog is not cooperating, is familiar ground.

I also led visitor tours of the campus library at the University of Austin, hosting groups of mixed ages and adjusting as I went depending on who was in front of me. That is the nearest thing I have to standing before a group inside a library, and it is a large part of why I am applying for this work rather than something else.

I would be learning the age-group craft from people who already do it well, and I would rather be honest about that at the outset than discover it at the desk.

7. Are you able to work nights and weekends?

Yes.